

BAG CHECK!

Level 3-4
10-20 minutes

Decide what comes with you on your next adventure

Topic:

Everyday decision making

Wellness Domain:

Intellectual / Physical

Goals:

Participant will use recognition and choice skills to prepare for a destination.

Materials (Included/Subs):

- 1 bag or container (tote, purse, backpack, pouch, or gallon-size zip bag)
- 8–12 everyday items or item cards, including a mix of:
 - Practical items (e.g., keys, wallet, glasses case, tissues)
 - Personal or comfort items (e.g., scarf, photo, small book, fidget)
 - Optional or less-needed items (e.g., extra pen, sunglasses indoors)
- Optional: Take/Leave cards (included)

Background:

Choose one scenario that is familiar, realistic, and relevant to the participant's life now and their personal preferences. If they are going somewhere, use this to help them prepare!

Materials should reflect the participant's lived experience. Swap items freely. Familiarity matters more than accuracy and there is no right answer. Items may be real objects, photos, or cards depending on ability and safety.

The goal is choice and thinking, not speed or accuracy. Follow the person's lead if a memory or story comes up. If an item sparks recognition or preference, it belongs in the 'Take' bag.

Examples on the next page to get you started!

Structure / Activity:

Getting started: Share the activity scenario and objective you chose. You can only take a few things with you. Decide what goes in the bag and what stays behind. Confirm understanding.

Steps:

1. Choose or create a scenario that fits the person.
2. Set up items
3. Explain the task. See "Getting started".
4. Invite Choices. Let them choose which items to take. Share 1 item, a few or all

at once.

5. Offer gentle prompts and be curious with questions. *This works throughout the activity.*
 - a. "Tell me about this one"
 - b. "Why are you taking this?"
6. Sort items into Take/Leave/Maybe
7. Close the activity. Affirm the choices. "You picked what works best for you!"
 - a. optional: discuss reasons, memories
 - b. optional: if real bag, help them find a place to keep it until needed.

Adaptations & Safety Precautions:

- Avoid hypothetical or fantasy scenarios unless the participant enjoys them.
- For more active seniors, let them walk around and collect items from the room or add a timer/friendly challenge element to the activity.
- Avoid sharp, breakable, or small items that could be a choking risk.

- Communication challenges? Pointing, nodding, touching are valid choices.

If the activity feels:

Too easy?

- Add a constraint ("You can only carry three.")

Too hard? Frustrating?

- Offer fewer items
- Use a binary choice (take / leave)
- Take a break or stop the activity

EXAMPLES

scenario:

Going to a relative's home for the afternoon. You're setting things up so it goes smoothly, what do you bring?

possible materials:

- | | | | |
|-----------|--------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| • keys | • image of towel | • tooth brush | • sunglasses |
| • wallet | • image of pajamas | • fork | • piece of fruit |
| • tissues | • office item | • image of host gift (flower bouquet) | • image of heavy jacket |
| • phone | | | • paint brush |

scenario:

Work ready: What would you have brought with you to work?

possible materials: (for former accountant)

- | | | | |
|-----------------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------|
| • keys | • calculator | • family photo | • fork |
| • wallet | • image of computer | • yarn | • sunglasses |
| • image of brief case | • image of suit | • work badge | • image of chef hat |
| • phone | • (image of) hammer | • medical gloves | • paperwork |

scenario:

Hobby Heaven: Pack a bag for your hobby (fishing, crafting, gardening)

possible materials:

- | | | | |
|---------------|-----------------------|---------------------|------------------|
| (for fishing) | • image of boat | • music | • family photo |
| | • fishing lure | • screwdriver | • fish spice mix |
| | • image of tackle box | • map | • fishing line |
| | • phone | • image of chef hat | • pencil |

Leave



Take